

Carry Out Efficient Server Management with Cockpit



Cockpit is a server management tool that is specially designed for new sysadmins. It allows them to perform simple tasks such as starting and stopping services, storage administration and journal inspection. Although it is a Web tool, switching to the terminal is seamless.

Cockpit is free and open source software offered by Red Hat. It is a new graphical interface for handling Linux server administration tasks. The Cockpit project was launched at the start of 2014 and is currently undergoing heavy development. Cockpit offers a wide variety of features such as LVM administration, journal logging, Docker integration, etc. It is not the first Web interface to manage Linux servers, but it is now attracting those who are interested in administering Linux from a Web interface rather than the command line.

Cockpit is a user-friendly Web UI that can be run via any browser. It also supports multi-server administration, which means that admins or users can manage multiple servers at the same time.

Installation on Fedora

As Cockpit is undergoing heavy development, there is no stable release for the OS except for Fedora 20 and Fedora 21. There are two ways to install Cockpit - the first is by using the YUM repository and the other by using the GitHub repository. It is recommended that you install Cockpit on a virtual machine since it is not yet production ready.

Using YUM

For the official stable release of Cockpit, use Fedora 21 server:

```
$ sudo yum install cockpit
$ sudo systemctl enable cockpit.socket
$ sudo systemctl start cockpit
$ sudo firewall-cmd --add-service=cockpit
```

To install Cockpit on Fedora 20, type:

```
$ sudo yum install --enablerepo=updates-testing cockpit
$ sudo systemctl enable cockpit.socket
$ sudo systemctl start cockpit
$ sudo firewall-cmd --add-service=cockpit
$ sudo setenforce 0 # fixed in rawhide
```

Using the GitHub repository

Cockpit can be also installed using the official source repository available on [github.com](https://github.com/cockpit-project/cockpit) - <https://github.com/cockpit-project/cockpit>